BY ENCHANTED MEDICAL AESTHETICS

LOW FODMAP STARTER GUIDE

Discover Foods That Support Digestive Comfort



www.enchantedmedicalaesthetics.com

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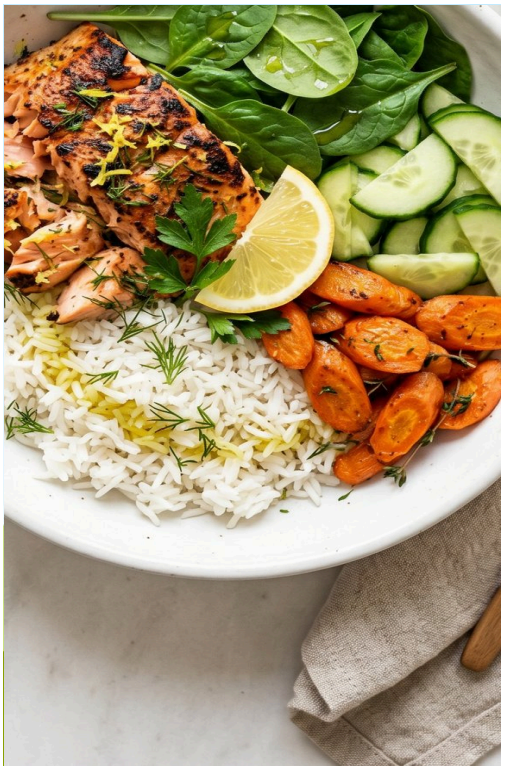
WELCOME

I’m Dr. Bridget Martin, a Doctor of Nursing Practice and founder of Enchanted Medical Aesthetics. I’m passionate about helping individuals navigate digestive challenges and build confidence around food through practical, evidence-informed care.

This guide was created to make the Low FODMAP approach simple, practical, and easier to follow in everyday life. It is designed to help you understand FODMAPs, make informed food choices, and navigate digestive health with greater confidence.

Inside, you'll find beginner-friendly guidance on foods to enjoy, foods to limit, meal-building strategies, grocery shopping tips, and practical tools to support your journey.

This guide is designed to help you identify potential food triggers, improve digestive comfort, and build greater confidence in making food choices that work for your body.



Let’s connect!

info@enchantedmedicalaesthetics.com

www.enchantedmedicalaesthetics.com

Ormond Beach
(386) 317-1449

DeLand
(386) 463-2660

Text to order
(706) 710-4015



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WHAT ARE FODMAPS?

What FODMAPs are and how they affect digestion

FODMAPs are a group of carbohydrates that can be difficult for some people to digest. The term stands for Fermentable Oligosaccharides, Disaccharides, Monosaccharides, and Polyols. These compounds are naturally found in a variety of foods, including certain fruits, vegetables, dairy products, grains, and sweeteners.

For some individuals, FODMAPs are not fully absorbed in the small intestine. When they reach the large intestine, they can draw water into the digestive tract and are fermented by gut bacteria. This process may contribute to symptoms such as bloating, gas, abdominal discomfort, and changes in bowel habits.

A Low FODMAP approach is a structured way to identify foods that may be contributing to digestive symptoms. It is not intended to be a lifelong restrictive diet. Instead, it helps create a more personalized eating pattern by identifying individual food triggers and supporting greater digestive comfort.

Did you know?

Not everyone reacts to the same FODMAP-containing foods. The goal of a Low FODMAP approach is not to eliminate these foods forever, but to identify your personal tolerance levels and build a diet that is both enjoyable and comfortable.

HOW FODMAPS AFFECT DIGESTION

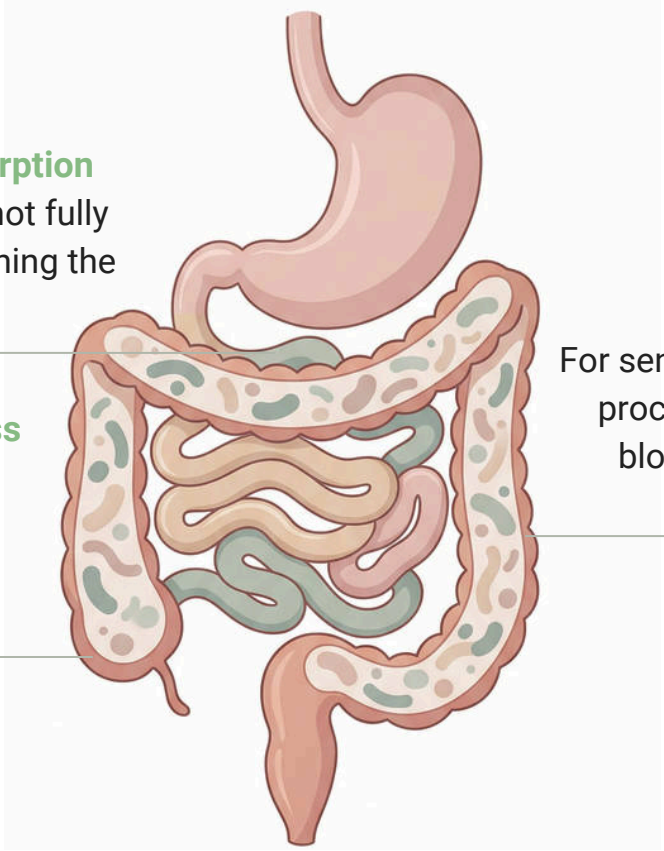
Why certain carbohydrates may contribute to digestive symptoms

FODMAPs are short-chain carbohydrates that can be difficult for some people to absorb completely. When these carbohydrates move through the digestive tract, they may draw extra water into the intestines and become fermented by gut bacteria.

For individuals who are sensitive to FODMAPs, this process can contribute to symptoms such as bloating, gas, abdominal discomfort, and changes in bowel habits. The Low FODMAP approach helps identify which foods may be contributing to these symptoms.

Small Intestine Absorption
Some FODMAPs are not fully absorbed before reaching the large intestine.

Fermentation Process
Gut bacteria ferment certain FODMAPs, producing gas as a natural byproduct.



Digestive Symptoms
For sensitive individuals, this process may contribute to bloating, discomfort, and changes in digestion.

Key insight

FODMAPs are not unhealthy foods. Many are highly nutritious. The goal of the Low FODMAP approach is to identify your personal tolerance levels and create a diet that supports digestive comfort.

WHO MAY BENEFIT FROM A LOW FODMAP DIET

Common digestive symptoms and situations where it may help

A Low FODMAP diet may be helpful for individuals experiencing ongoing digestive symptoms or those looking to better understand how certain foods affect their digestion.

While it is most commonly used for managing digestive discomfort, the approach is designed to identify personal food triggers and support a more comfortable, individualized way of eating.

People with IBS

A Low FODMAP approach is commonly used to help manage symptoms associated with Irritable Bowel Syndrome, including bloating, gas, abdominal discomfort, and changes in bowel habits.

People with Frequent Digestive Symptoms

Individuals who regularly experience digestive discomfort after meals may benefit from identifying foods that are less well tolerated and recognizing potential dietary triggers.

People Looking to Identify Food Triggers

The Low FODMAP approach provides a structured framework for understanding how specific foods may affect digestion and overall comfort.



Everyone's digestion is unique.

A Low FODMAP approach helps identify personal food triggers and build a way of eating that supports greater comfort and confidence.

THE THREE PHASES OF THE LOW FODMAP APPROACH

A step-by-step process for identifying personal food triggers

The Low FODMAP approach is a structured dietary strategy designed to help identify foods that may contribute to digestive symptoms. Rather than focusing on permanent restriction, it provides a step-by-step process for better understanding individual food tolerances and digestive responses.

The approach consists of three phases that work together to identify potential triggers, assess tolerance levels, and build a more personalized eating pattern. Each phase has a specific purpose and helps guide the transition toward greater digestive comfort and long-term dietary variety.

Phase 1: Elimination
During this phase, foods high in FODMAPs are temporarily reduced for a limited period. The goal is to create a consistent foundation that allows individuals to observe whether symptoms improve when potential triggers are minimized.

Phase 2: Reintroduction
Foods are gradually reintroduced in a structured manner to evaluate tolerance levels. This phase helps identify which FODMAP groups may contribute to symptoms and which foods can be comfortably included in the diet.

Phase 3: Personalization
The information gathered during reintroduction is used to create a balanced and sustainable eating pattern. The focus shifts toward including as many well-tolerated foods as possible while supporting ongoing digestive comfort.

Why This Process Matters

The goal of the Low FODMAP approach is not permanent restriction. By identifying personal tolerance levels, individuals can enjoy greater food variety while supporting long-term digestive comfort and confidence around eating.



PHASE 1: ELIMINATION

Foods higher in FODMAPs are temporarily reduced to create a clear starting point and help determine whether they may be contributing to digestive symptoms.

Most people follow the elimination phase for 2–6 weeks. The goal is to observe how the body responds when common high FODMAP foods are minimized and to track any changes in digestive comfort.

If symptoms improve, the next step is reintroduction, where foods are gradually tested to identify individual tolerance levels and build a more personalized eating pattern.

Common High FODMAP Foods

Fruits
- Apples
- Pears
- Watermelon

Dairy Products
- Milk
- Soft cheeses
- Ice cream

Vegetables
- Garlic
- Onions
- Cauliflower

Legumes
- Beans
- Lentils
- Chickpeas

Grains & Sweeteners
- Wheat-based breads
- Wheat bread
- Regular pasta
- Honey
- High-fructose sweeteners



PHASE 2: REINTRODUCTION

The reintroduction phase begins after the elimination phase has been completed. During this stage, foods containing specific FODMAP groups are gradually added back into the diet in a structured way to assess how the body responds.

Rather than reintroducing all foods at once, individual FODMAP groups are tested one at a time. This approach helps identify which foods are well tolerated and which may contribute to digestive symptoms, creating a clearer picture of personal tolerance levels.

The information gathered during reintroduction provides the foundation for the final personalization phase. The goal is to expand food variety whenever possible while maintaining digestive comfort and confidence around eating.

Test One Group at a Time
Focus on a single FODMAP category before moving to the next.

Start with Small Portions
Gradually increase serving sizes to assess tolerance levels.

Track Your Responses
Record symptoms and observations throughout the testing process.



PHASE 3: PERSONALIZATION

After completing the reintroduction phase, the focus shifts toward building a personalized eating pattern based on your individual tolerance levels. Foods that are well tolerated can gradually be reintroduced, while foods that consistently trigger symptoms may be limited or adjusted.

The personalization phase is designed to increase dietary variety while maintaining digestive comfort. Rather than following a highly restrictive plan, the goal is to create a flexible approach that includes as many foods as possible while supporting your unique needs.

Key Principles of Personalization

Prioritize Tolerated Foods

Build meals around foods that support comfort and enjoyment.

Monitor Individual Triggers

Pay attention to foods that consistently cause symptoms.

Expand Food Variety

Include a wide range of well-tolerated foods whenever possible.

Create a Sustainable Routine

Choose an eating pattern that feels realistic for everyday life.

LOW FODMAP SUCCESS FRAMEWORK

Key principles for navigating the Low FODMAP journey



Learn the Basics
Understand what FODMAPs are and how they may affect digestion.



Start with Elimination
Temporarily reduce high FODMAP foods to assess symptom changes.



Reintroduce Systematically
Test foods one group at a time to identify tolerance levels.



Personalize Your Diet
Build meals around foods that support digestive comfort.



Focus on Long-Term Variety
Include as many well-tolerated foods as possible.

PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

The Low FODMAP approach is designed to help you better understand your body's unique responses to food. By moving through each phase in a structured way, you can gather valuable information about your personal tolerance levels and dietary needs.

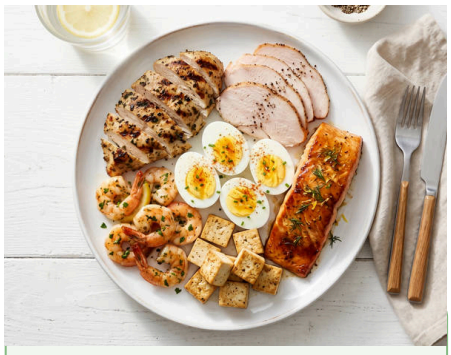
While some foods may be limited during the process, the ultimate goal is to create a balanced and sustainable eating pattern. Many individuals find that they can successfully reintroduce a wide variety of foods while maintaining digestive comfort.

Remember that the Low FODMAP approach is not about achieving perfection. It is a tool for learning, experimenting, and building confidence around food choices that work for your body.

The goal is not to eat fewer foods forever.
The goal is to identify the foods that help you feel your best while maintaining as much variety as possible.

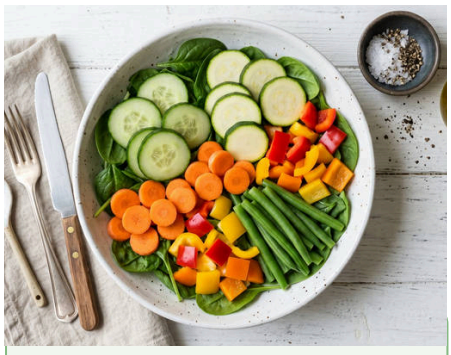
FOODS TO ENJOY

Everyday foods to enjoy on Low FODMAP



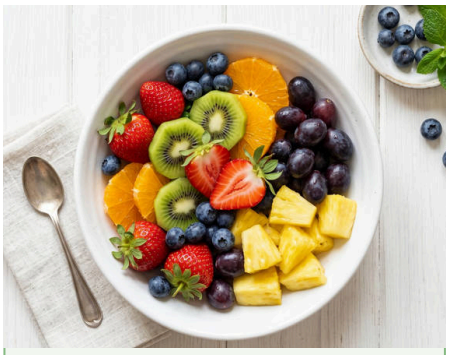
Protein Foods

Protein supports fullness, muscle maintenance, and overall nutrition while fitting easily into a Low FODMAP eating pattern.
Examples: Chicken, turkey, fish, eggs, firm tofu, shrimp.



Vegetables

Low FODMAP vegetables provide fiber, vitamins, and minerals for balanced meals.
Examples: Spinach, carrots, zucchini, cucumbers, bell peppers, green beans.



Fruits

Many fruits can be enjoyed in appropriate portions as part of a Low FODMAP diet.
Examples: Strawberries, blueberries, kiwi, oranges, grapes, pineapple.



Low FODMAP Grains

Low FODMAP grains provide steady energy and help create satisfying, balanced meals.
Examples: Rice, quinoa, oats, corn, buckwheat, rice noodles.



Healthy Fats

Healthy fats support meal satisfaction and nutrient absorption.
Examples: Olive oil, walnuts, pecans, macadamia nuts, chia seeds.

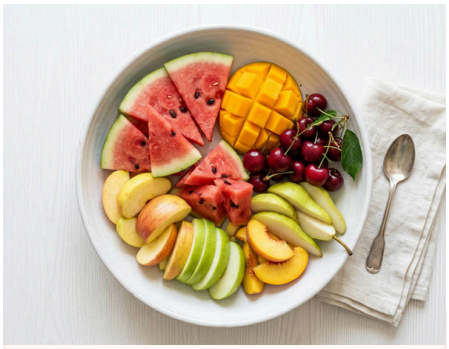


Dairy & Alternatives

Lactose-free and dairy-free options help add variety to meals and snacks.
Examples: Lactose-free milk, lactose-free yogurt, hard cheeses, almond milk.

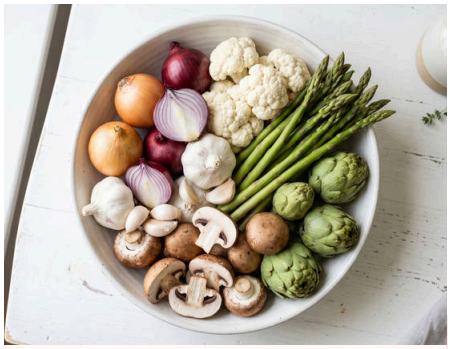
FOODS TO LIMIT

Common high FODMAP foods to be aware of



High FODMAP Fruits

Some fruits contain higher amounts of FODMAPs and may contribute to digestive symptoms in sensitive individuals.
Examples: Apples, pears, watermelon, mango, cherries, peaches.



High FODMAP Vegetables

Certain vegetables contain carbohydrates that may be less well tolerated during the Low FODMAP approach.
Examples: Onions, garlic, cauliflower, asparagus, mushrooms, artichokes.



Legumes

Many legumes contain higher levels of FODMAPs and are commonly reduced during the elimination phase.
Examples: Baked beans, kidney beans, chickpeas, lentils (large portions).



Wheat-Based Foods

Some wheat-based products contain FODMAPs that may contribute to digestive discomfort.
Examples: Regular bread, pasta, crackers, bagels, pastries.



Sweeteners & Processed Foods

Sweeteners and processed foods may contain higher FODMAPs.
Examples: Honey, agave syrup, high-fructose corn syrup, sugar-free products containing polyols.



Dairy Products

Dairy products containing lactose may be difficult for some individuals to tolerate.
Examples: Milk, soft cheeses, ice cream, regular yogurt.

BUILDING BALANCED LOW FODMAP MEALS

A simple approach to creating Low FODMAP-friendly meals

Fill Half Your Plate with Low FODMAP Vegetables

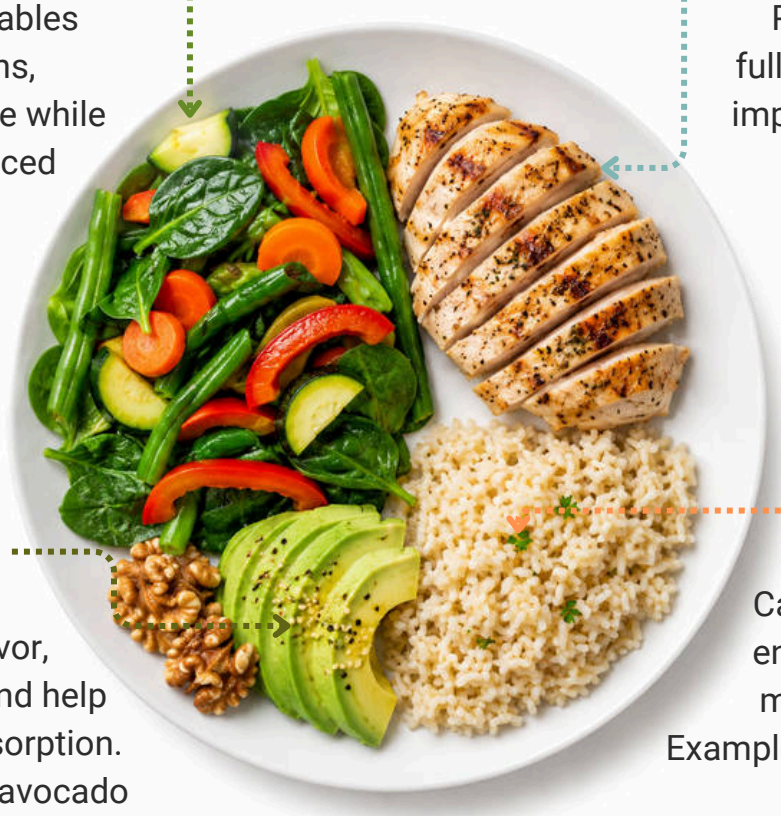
Low FODMAP vegetables provide fiber, vitamins, minerals, and volume while helping create balanced meals.

Examples: Spinach, carrots, zucchini, cucumbers, bell peppers, green beans, lettuce.

Finish with Healthy Fats

Healthy fats add flavor, meal satisfaction, and help support nutrient absorption.

Examples: Olive oil, avocado (small portions), walnuts, pecans, chia seeds.



Build Every Meal Around Protein

Protein helps support fullness and provides an important foundation for balanced meals.

Examples: Chicken, turkey, fish, eggs, firm tofu, shrimp, lean beef.

Add Low FODMAP Carbohydrates

Carbohydrates provide energy and help create more satisfying meals.

Examples: Rice, quinoa, oats, corn, buckwheat, rice noodles, potatoes.

THE LOW FODMAP PLATE METHOD

A balanced Low FODMAP meal includes vegetables, protein, carbohydrates, and healthy fats. Combining these foods can help create meals that are satisfying, nourishing, and easier to enjoy with confidence.

Aim to fill about half your plate with Low FODMAP vegetables, add a source of protein, include a serving of Low FODMAP carbohydrates, and finish with a small amount of healthy fats.

GROCERY SHOPPING MADE SIMPLE

Low FODMAP staples to keep on hand

LEAN PROTEINS

- Chicken breast
- Turkey breast
- Lean beef
- Pork tenderloin
- Salmon
- White fish
- Tuna
- Shrimp
- Eggs
- Egg whites
- Firm tofu
- Tempeh

FRESH VEGETABLES

- Spinach
- Lettuce
- Arugula
- Kale
- Zucchini
- Carrots
- Cucumbers
- Bell peppers
- Green beans
- Bok choy
- Eggplant
- Tomatoes
- Radishes

FRUITS

- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Raspberries
- Blackberries
- Oranges
- Clementines
- Kiwi
- Grapes
- Pineapple
- Cantaloupe
- Honeydew melon
- Passion fruit
- Lemon

LOW FODMAP GRAINS

- Rice
- Brown rice
- Quinoa
- Oats
- Buckwheat
- Millet
- Polenta
- Corn tortillas
- Rice noodles
- Gluten-free pasta
- Potatoes
- Sweet potatoes
- Gluten-free bread
- Rice cakes
- Popcorn

HEALTHY FATS

- Olive oil
- Avocado (small portions)
- Walnuts
- Pecans
- Macadamia nuts
- Brazil nuts
- Peanuts
- Chia seeds
- Pumpkin seeds
- Flaxseeds
- Sunflower seeds
- Tahini
- Olives
- Natural peanut butter
- Natural almond butter

PANTRY STAPLES & CONDIMENTS

- Garlic-infused olive oil
- Herbs and spices
- Fresh ginger
- Mustard
- Balsamic vinegar
- Rice vinegar
- Tamari
- Canned tomatoes
- Maple syrup
- Unsweetened almond milk
- Canned tuna
- Canned salmon
- Sea salt
- Black pepper

READING FOOD LABELS

Simple ways to identify potential high FODMAP ingredients

Food labels can help you identify ingredients that may be higher in FODMAPs. While not every packaged food needs to be avoided, learning what to look for can make shopping easier and help you make more informed choices.

Common Ingredients to Watch For

Sweeteners
- Honey
- Agave syrup
- High-fructose corn syrup

Onion
- Onion powder
- Dried onion
- Onion flakes

Polyols
- Sorbitol
- Mannitol
- Xylitol
- Maltitol

Garlic
- Garlic powder
- Dried garlic
- Garlic paste



Better Label Habits

Read the Full Ingredient List
Ingredients often provide more useful information than the nutrition facts panel when following a Low FODMAP approach.

Watch for Hidden Sweeteners
Honey, agave syrup, and high-fructose corn syrup can increase the FODMAP content of a product and may affect tolerance.

Check for Onion and Garlic
These ingredients often appear in packaged foods and may contribute to symptoms.

Choose Simple Ingredient Lists
Simple ingredient lists are often easier to evaluate and include in a Low FODMAP diet.

EVERYDAY TIPS FOR SUCCESS

Simple habits that can help make Low FODMAP living easier

Tip 1: Plan Ahead

Keeping a few Low FODMAP staples on hand can make meals and snacks easier to prepare throughout the week and help reduce last-minute food decisions.

Tip 2: Keep a Food Journal

Tracking meals, symptoms, portion sizes, and food choices may help identify patterns and personal triggers over time.

Tip 3: Try New Foods Gradually

Introducing new foods one at a time can make it easier to assess tolerance levels and better understand your body's responses.

Tip 4: Read Labels Consistently

Checking ingredient lists regularly can help identify potential high FODMAP ingredients before purchasing products.

Tip 5: Focus on Variety

Including a range of well-tolerated foods can help support balanced nutrition and long-term meal enjoyment.

Tip 6: Be Flexible

Food tolerance levels can vary over time, so use the Low FODMAP approach as a practical guide.



Remember

The Low FODMAP approach is a learning process, not a test of perfection. Small, consistent habits can help build confidence, improve meal planning, and make it easier to create an eating pattern that supports your individual needs and digestive comfort.



TRACKING SYMPTOMS & FOOD TRIGGERS

Using observations to better understand your digestive responses

Keeping track of meals, symptoms, and food choices can provide valuable insights during the Low FODMAP journey. While not every symptom is food-related, consistent tracking may help identify patterns, recognize potential triggers, and support more informed food decisions over time.

WHAT TO TRACK

- **Foods & Drinks:** Record meals, snacks, beverages, and portion sizes whenever possible.
- **Digestive Symptoms:** Note symptoms such as bloating, gas, abdominal discomfort, diarrhea, or constipation.
- **Timing:** Pay attention to when symptoms occur in relation to meals and snacks.

Why Tracking Matters

Tracking meals and symptoms can help identify patterns between food choices and digestive comfort. Over time, you may notice how certain foods, portion sizes, or eating habits affect your symptoms.

These observations can provide valuable insights during the reintroduction and personalization phases, helping you make more informed food choices based on your individual tolerance levels.

3-DAY LOW FODMAP MEAL PLAN

Simple meal ideas for balanced Low FODMAP eating



DAY 1

- Breakfast: Lactose-free yogurt bowl with mixed berries, chia seeds, and oats
- Lunch: Grilled chicken rice bowl with spinach, cucumber, carrots, and olive oil
- Dinner: Baked salmon with roasted potatoes, zucchini, and green beans
- Snack: Rice cakes with peanut butter



DAY 2

- Breakfast: Scrambled eggs with spinach, tomatoes, and gluten-free toast
- Lunch: Turkey quinoa bowl with bell peppers, lettuce, cucumber, and herbs
- Dinner: Shrimp rice noodle bowl with bok choy, carrots, and garlic-infused oil
- Snack: Kiwi with lactose-free yogurt



DAY 3

- Breakfast: Oatmeal with banana slices, walnuts, and lactose-free milk
- Lunch: Tuna potato salad with lettuce, cucumber, carrots, and olive oil dressing
- Dinner: Beef and rice bowl with zucchini, bell peppers, spinach, and green beans
- Snack: Orange slices with a small handful of walnuts

These meal ideas are meant to provide simple inspiration rather than strict rules. Mix and match Low FODMAP proteins, vegetables, carbohydrates, and healthy fats to create balanced meals that feel practical, flexible, and easier to follow.



YOUR NEXT STEPS

Completing the Low FODMAP journey is not about following a restrictive diet forever. The information gathered throughout the elimination and reintroduction phases can help you better understand your individual tolerance levels and create a more personalized approach to eating.

As you move forward, focus on including as many well-tolerated foods as possible. A varied diet can help support nutritional balance, meal enjoyment, and long-term sustainability while reducing the need for unnecessary restrictions.

Remember that food tolerance is highly individual and may change over time. What works well for one person may not work the same way for another, which is why ongoing observation and flexibility can be valuable.

Most importantly, use the Low FODMAP approach as a tool for learning rather than a set of strict rules. The goal is to build confidence around food choices, support digestive comfort, and create an eating pattern that fits your unique needs and lifestyle.



THANK YOU

Thank you for trusting Enchanted Medical Aesthetics with your wellness journey. Use this guide as your starting point, and bring your questions to your next visit. Our team is here to support you every step of the way.

DR. BRIDGET MARTIN, DNP, APRN, NP-C
Doctor of Nursing Practice
info@enchantedmedicalaesthetics.com